Combat rule – Two-weapon fighting · SRD 5.2.1

With the **Light** property, after you take the **Attack** action with a Light weapon, you can make a **bonus-action attack** with a **different** Light weapon in your other hand. You **don't** add your modifier to that attack's damage unless it is negative.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. **Attack** action with a **Light** weapon.
2. Then **bonus action**: a different **Light** weapon.
3. No **modifier** to damage (unless negative).
4. **Nick** mastery: the attack folds into the action.

⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 drops "two-weapon fighting" as a rule: everything goes through the Light property and the Nick mastery.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The SRD doesn't say whether you can swap weapons between the two attacks. Fix: one free object interaction per turn lets you draw.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe the flow: a parry, then a strike from the other hand.

Step 1 – Weapons:

A Light weapon in each hand.

Step 2 – Attack:

Take the Attack action with one weapon (hit or not).

Step 3 – Bonus action:

Attack with the other Light weapon, not the first one.

Step 4 – Damage:

Don't add the ability modifier, unless it's negative.

Step 5 – Nick:

If you have the mastery, the extra attack is part of the Attack action, once per turn.

Example: Mira (Dex +3) attacks with a dagger (1d4+3), then as a bonus action with the other (1d4, no +3).

⚠ Common questions:

Which weapons?

Two different Light weapons.

Must the first attack hit?

No, only the Attack action matters.

Does the modifier apply?

No, unless it's negative.

Can I throw two daggers?

Each throw follows its own rules.

With Extra Attack?

Yes, the bonus attack comes after the Attack action.

A two-handed weapon?

No, you need a weapon in each hand.

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Modifier to damage

Add it to the bonus attack? **Option**: no (SRD rule).

Drawing weapons

Draw as a free interaction. **Option**: one per turn.

Shield

Can I use a shield and a light weapon? **Option**: no.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Light weapon

Only Light weapons allow this attack.

Bonus action

One bonus action per turn.

No modifier

This attack adds the dice only.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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